

Accenture x SUBAA People Analytics Challenge 2026

NovaCorp CHRO Briefing

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# Three findings explain where NovaCorp's people cost is really coming from

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- NovaCorp's CHRO asked us to explain what is driving an estimated \$42M annual people cost, and to advise where to focus first.
- Triangulating four datasets, we identified three distinct, targetable drivers — each with a different root cause and a different fix.

### FINDING 1

**Entity\_B's high attrition is a leadership-trust problem, not a pay problem**

**~\$5.6M/yr at risk**

### FINDING 2

**Risk & Compliance is losing its most senior veterans to the external market**

**~\$2.6M/yr at risk**

### FINDING 3

**22.5% of active staff are disengaged — and they aren't the ones leaving**

**up to \$59M/yr exposure**

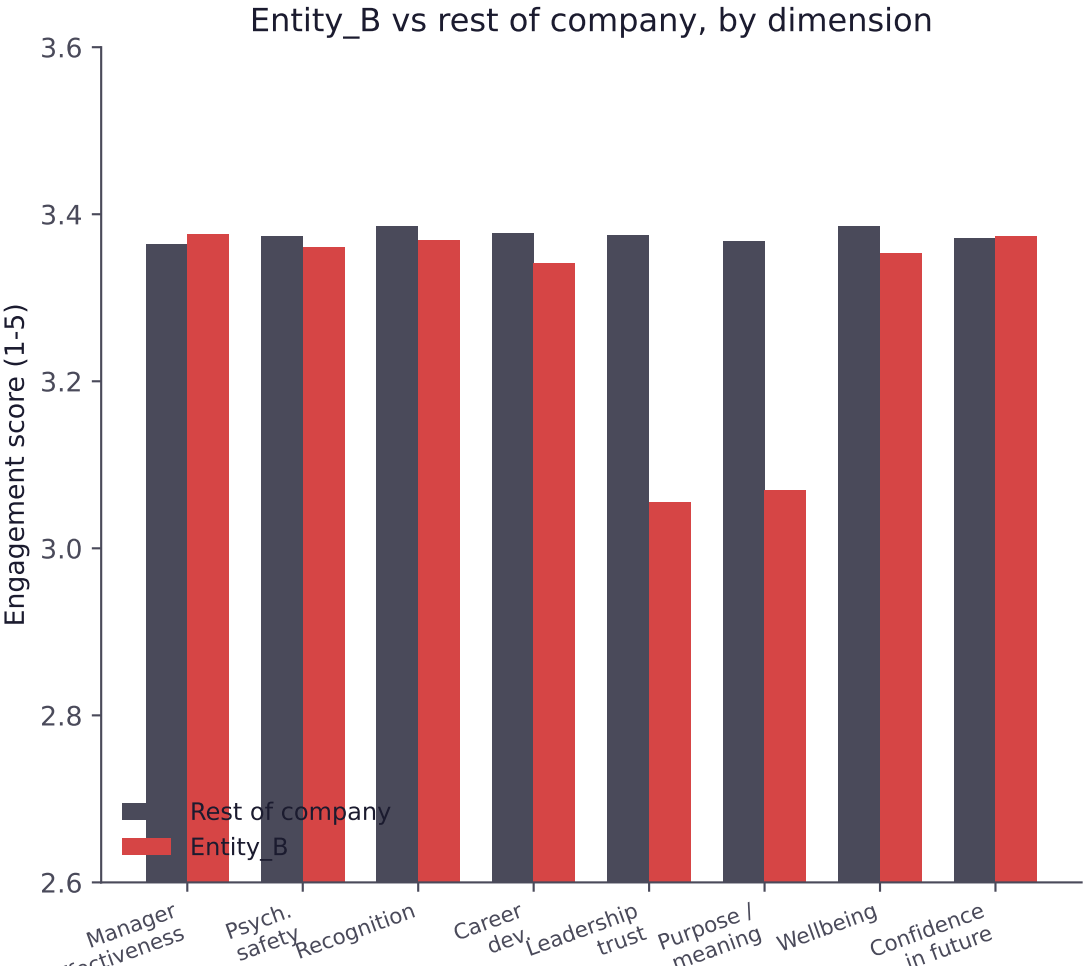
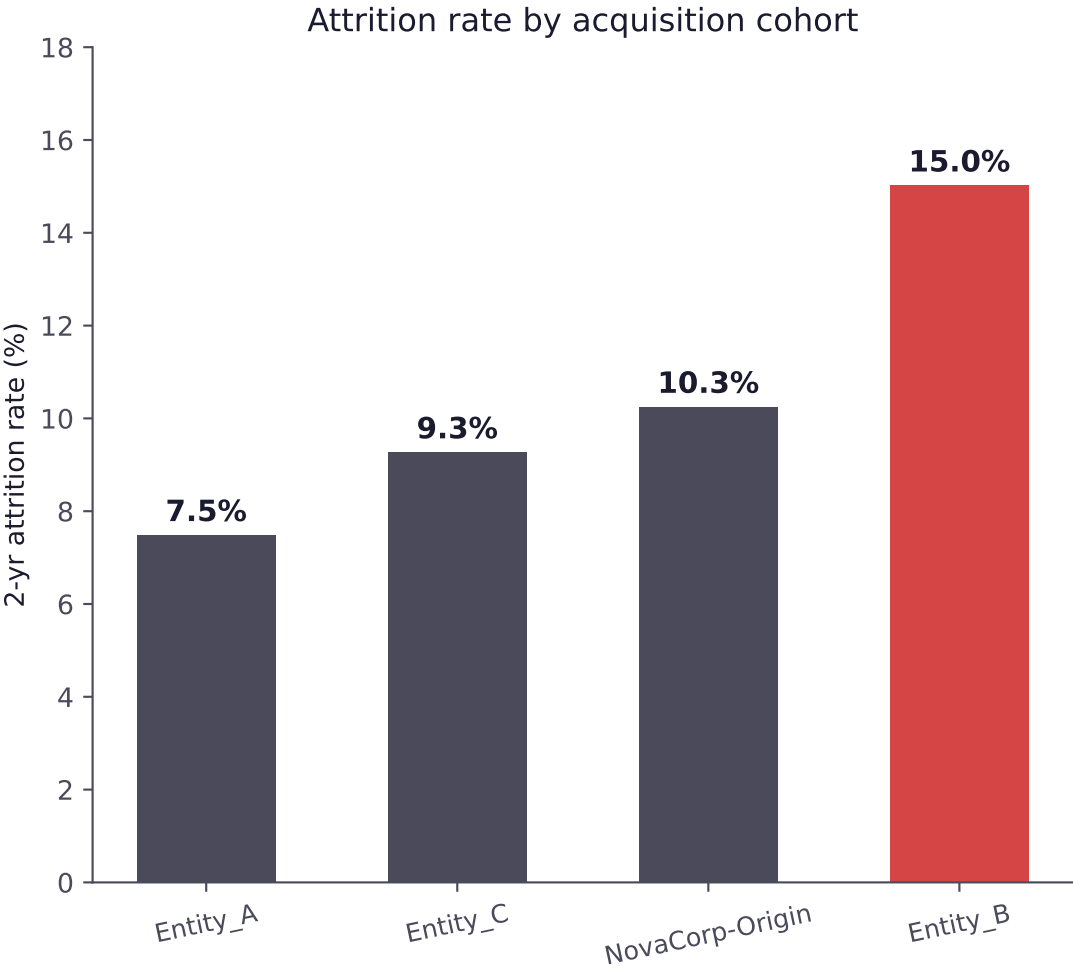
# Four datasets, triangulated — not taken at face value

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- employees.csv (13,403), attrition\_log.csv (1,400), engagement.csv (56,000 rows / 5 waves), performance.csv (35,000 rows) — joined on employee\_id, Jan 2024-Dec 2025 window.
- Key data decisions we made and documented:
- Population choice varies by question: active-only for org snapshots, full roster (active+departed) for attrition-risk denominators.
- stated\_exit\_reason, regrettable\_flag are retrospective HR judgements — used as one signal, always cross-checked against engagement/performance trajectories.
- Survey non-response rows are kept, not dropped — non-response turns out to be a signal in its own right (see Finding 3).
- We tested and ruled out a 'bad manager' narrative — team-level attrition shows ~zero correlation with team engagement scores.

FINDING 1 OF 3

Entity\_B's high attrition is a leadership-trust problem, not a pay problem



Every other dimension is in line with the company — the gap is specifically leadership trust and purpose. Compensation is not the driver: Entity\_B's avg compa-ratio (0.96) is above

## A specific, targetable cohort with a clear financial case

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- Corroborating signal: Entity\_B's survey response rate is 62.6%, vs 83.6% for the rest of the company — Entity\_B staff are checking out of the HR process itself.
- Among Entity\_B's high-value staff (L3+ / HiPo): 15.5% attrition and a 5.1% regrettable-flag rate — both the highest of any acquisition cohort.

**48**

Entity\_B high-value  
voluntary departures (2yr)

**\$163.8K**

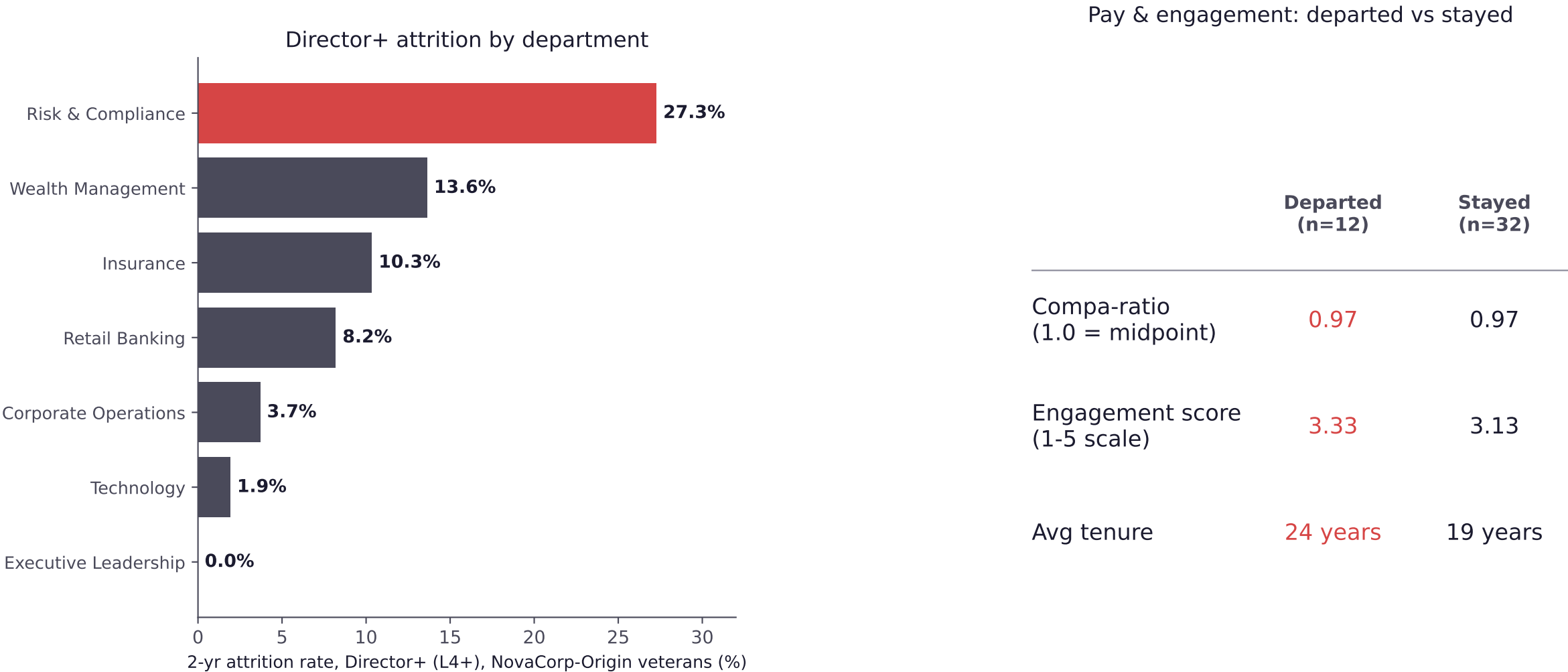
Average salary  
of departed staff

**~\$5.6M/yr**

Replacement cost exposure  
if unaddressed

FINDING 2 OF 3

Risk & Compliance is losing its most senior veterans to the external market



Departed staff were paid the same and engaged at least as well as those who stayed — this rules out pay and engagement as the driver.

## A small, identifiable, high-value flight-risk cohort

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- 8 of 12 departures cite "Career advancement" or "Better opportunity" as exit reason — consistent with the Annual Report's own account that FAR (Financial Accountability Regime) has intensified external competition for senior regulatory talent.
- These are long-tenured veterans: average tenure of ~24 years. Each departure carries institutional and regulatory knowledge that is not captured in the salary cost alone.

**27.3%**

Attrition rate — 2x the next-highest department/level cohort

**12 of 44**

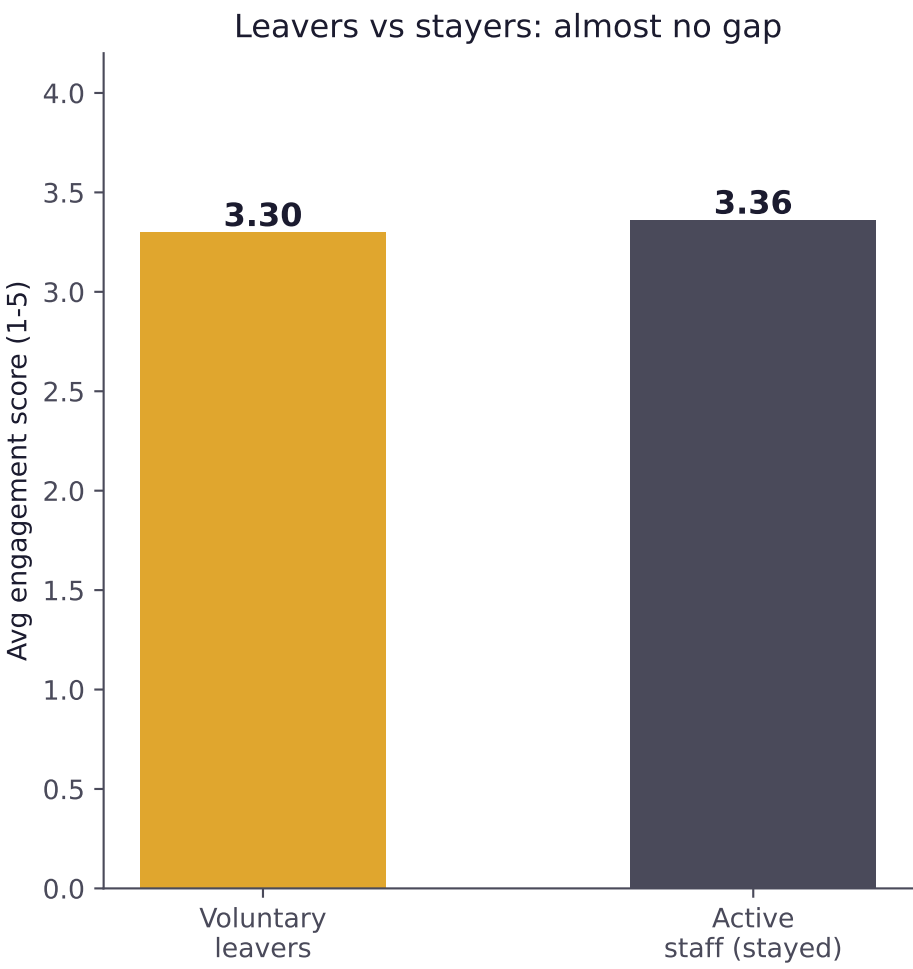
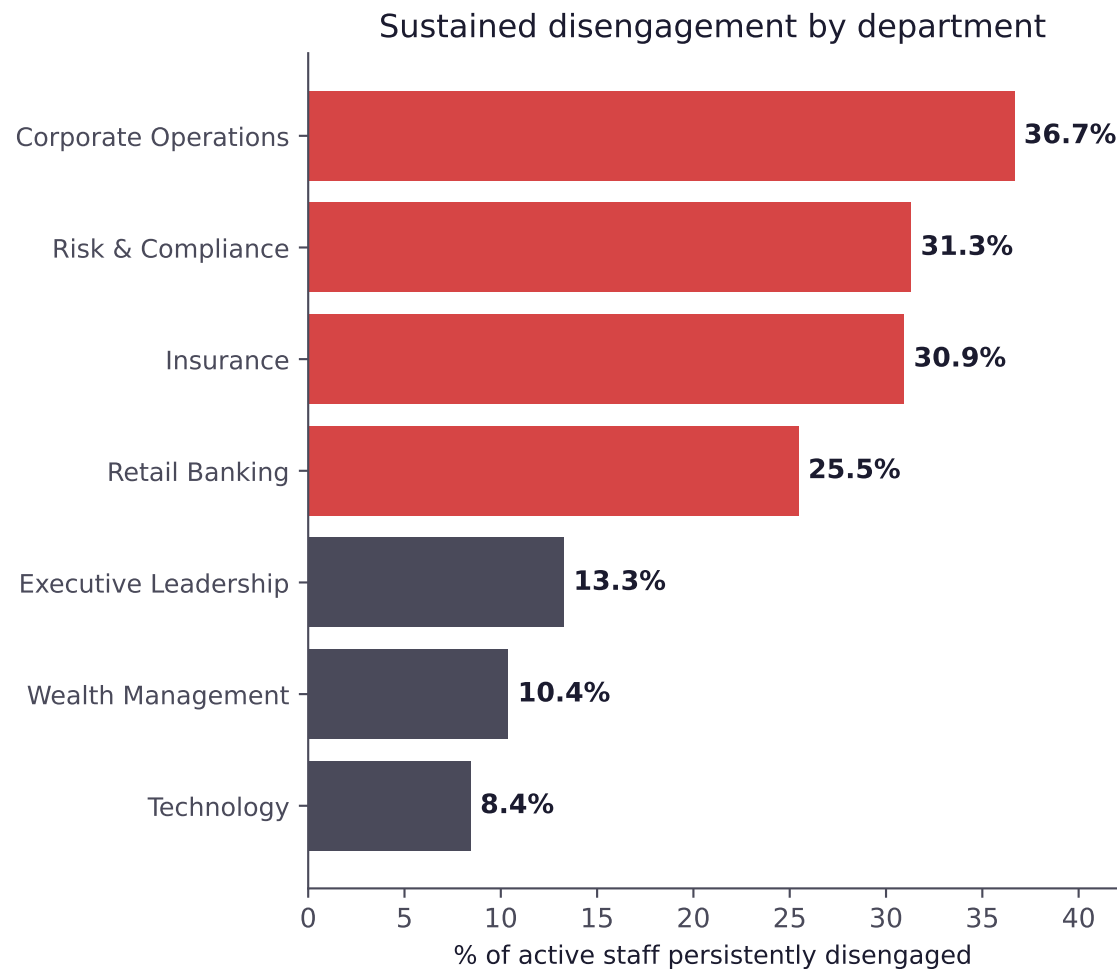
Veteran Directors lost  
(2-year window)

**~\$2.6M/yr**

Replacement cost, excluding  
knowledge-loss risk

FINDING 3 OF 3

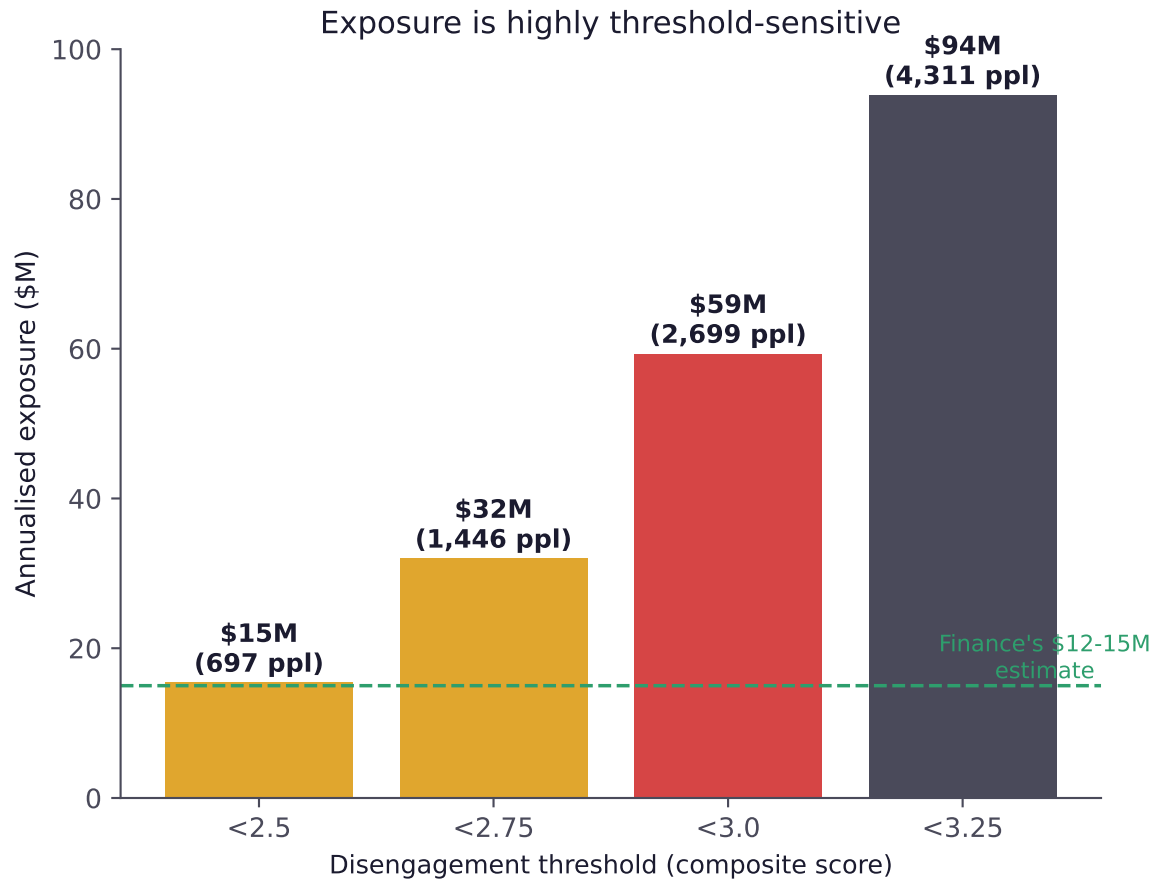
22.5% of active staff are disengaged — and they aren't the ones leaving



Attrition data alone would completely miss this problem: people who are disengaged mostly stay, not leave.



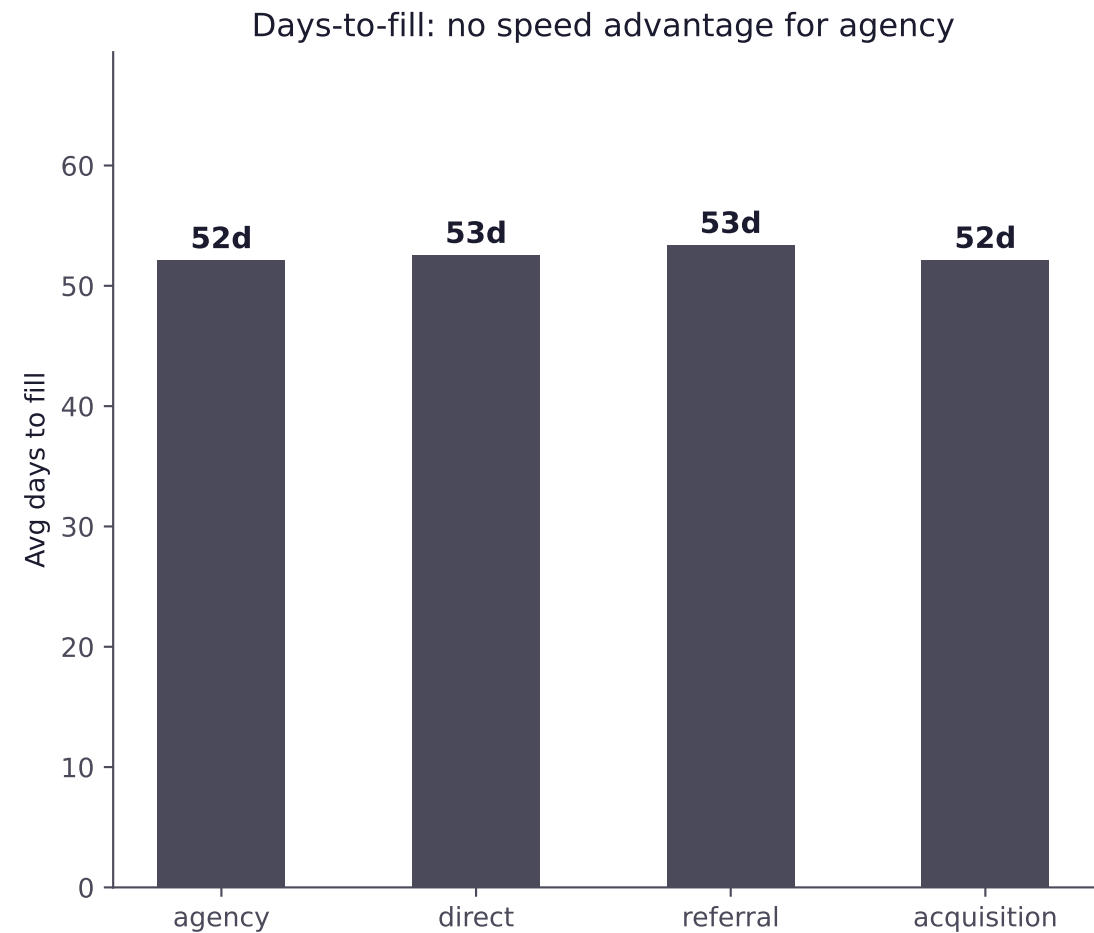
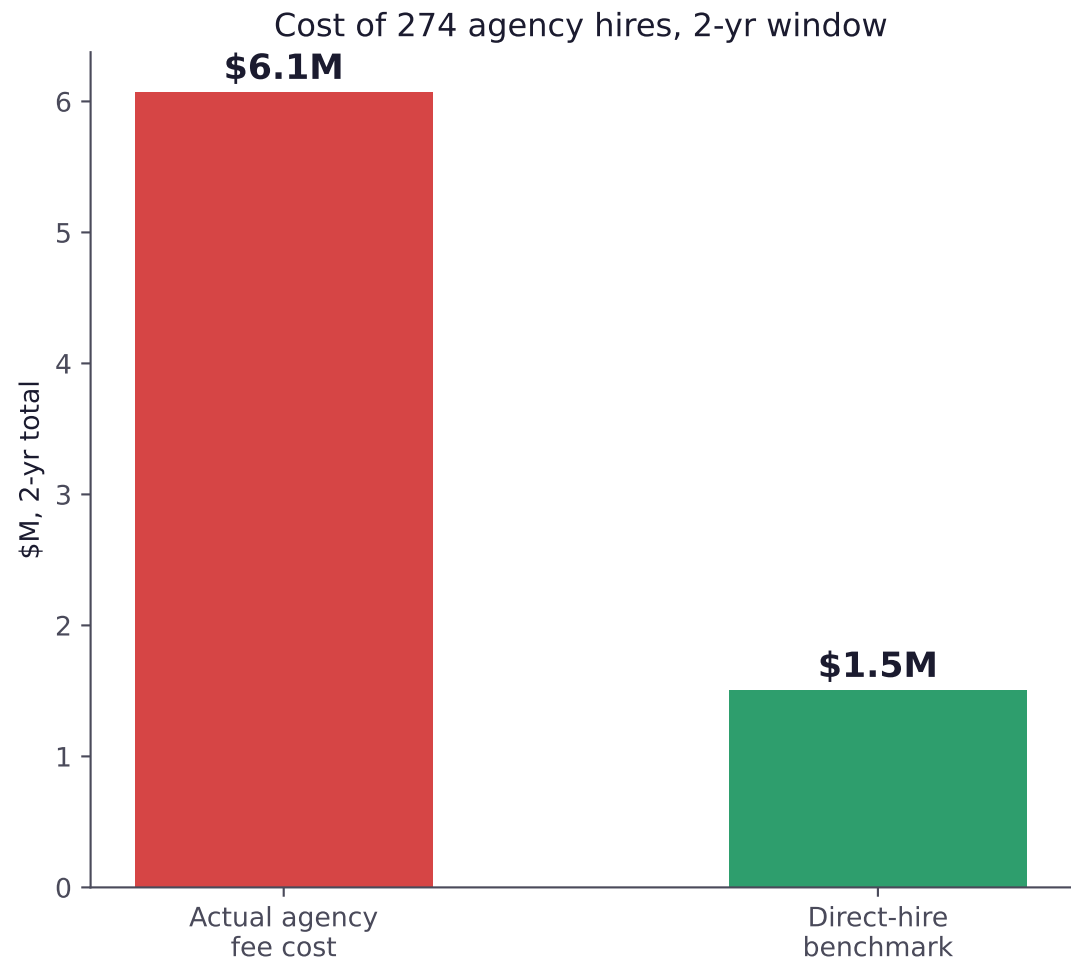
## Sizing the exposure honestly: it depends where you draw the line



- Finance's \$12-15M implies a severe-only population (~6% of staff, score <2.5) — we find nearly 4x that many showing sustained disengagement.
- Actionable target: bottom decile (1,156 people, ~\$25M/yr exposure).
- Limitation: goal-achievement scores do not differ significantly between disengaged and engaged staff ( $p=0.16$ ). This is a population-size estimate under Finance's own assumption — not a proven output deficit.

QUICK WIN

Agency hiring costs more, with no speed benefit and slightly worse retention



Excess agency cost is about \$2.3M/yr in fees, plus about \$2.3M/yr in poor-match early-exit backfill, about \$4.6M/yr total — closely matches Finance's own \$4-6M estimate.

# The recomputed \$42M: two buckets need re-calibrating

| Component                                        | Finance estimate | Data-derived (annualised) | Read                          |
|--------------------------------------------------|------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Regrettable attrition (HR-flagged, strict)       | \$22-25M         | \$14.3M                   | Likely under-flagged by HR    |
| Regrettable attrition (all high-value voluntary) | —                | \$30.6M                   | Broader lens exceeds estimate |
| Disengagement loss (severe, <2.5 score)          | \$12-15M         | \$15.4M                   | Matches Finance closely       |
| Disengagement loss (sustained, <3.0 score)       | —                | up to \$59.3M             | Long tail not yet budgeted    |
| Hiring inefficiency                              | \$4-6M           | \$4.6M                    | Well-calibrated already       |

Key takeaway: HR's own retrospective 'regrettable' label likely undercounts true cost, while disengagement carries a much larger long tail than currently priced in.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

# A 90-day, sequenced plan — not a blanket program

NOW (0-30 days)

\$0 incremental cost

**Deploy a disengagement early-warning trigger**

Flag anyone completing <60% of surveys for a manager check-in within 2 weeks.  
This signal predicts voluntary exit 3x better than the score itself (21.2% vs 6.8%).  
Pilot in Corp Ops, Risk & Compliance, Insurance first.

THIS QUARTER

Protects ~\$5.6M/yr

**Entity\_B Leadership Reconnection Programme**

ELT roadshow + listening tour for Entity\_B (prioritise 354 high-value staff).  
Targets leadership trust (3.05→3.38) and purpose (3.06→3.38), not pay.  
Timed to the Q2 FY26 integration completion already committed to.

THIS QUARTER (parallel)

Protects ~\$2.6M/yr

**Critical Regulatory Talent Retention track**

External market compensation benchmarking for R&C Director+ (44 people).  
Accelerated recognition + succession/knowledge-transfer safety net.  
Addresses external FAR-driven poaching, not an internal engagement gap.

## What happens if NovaCorp acts

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~\$10.5M/yr

Protected replacement cost:  
Entity\_B + R&C Director+ cohorts  
normalised to company-average attrition

~\$25M/yr

Disengagement exposure addressed  
by targeting the bottom-decile  
cohort (1,156 people) first

~\$2.3M/yr

Hiring-fee savings from shifting  
discretionary agency hires to  
direct/referral pipelines

- Measurement: Entity\_B leadership\_trust & purpose\_meaning scores, and Entity\_B voluntary attrition rate, tracked at the next 2 survey waves.
- R&C Director+ retention rate and time-to-fill for critical regulatory roles.
- Bottom-decile disengagement headcount, tracked wave-over-wave.
- Agency vs direct/referral hire mix, tracked quarterly.

## Limitations, stated explicitly

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- Dataset-derived voluntary attrition (~5%/yr) is materially lower than the Annual Report's headline figure (10.4% FY2025). We treat the CSV datasets as ground truth per the Case Brief; the Annual Report is used only for qualitative context.
- `stated_exit_reason`, `regrettable_flag` and `performance_band_at_exit` are retrospective HR judgements, not verified fact — used as one signal, cross-checked against engagement/performance trajectories, never taken alone.
- Disengagement's link to measured output (`goal_achievement_score`) is not statistically significant in this data ( $p=0.16$ ) — our \$ estimate sizes the population under Finance's flat-rate assumption; it does not prove a current productivity deficit.
- We tested and ruled out a manager-driven attrition narrative (correlation  $\approx 0$  between team engagement and team attrition) — deliberately not pursued further.
- 2025-H2 performance reviews are absent from the data; no claims made about the most recent half-year of performance.

# The \$42M is not one problem. It's three, and we know where they live.

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Entity\_B: leadership trust & purpose, not pay — ~\$5.6M/yr at risk

Risk & Compliance Director+: external market poaching — ~\$2.6M/yr at risk

Stay-but-disengaged: 22.5% of active staff, largely invisible to exit data — up to \$59M/yr exposure

Quick win: redirect agency hiring — ~\$2.3M/yr saved, funds the rest

Thank you — questions welcome.

## Data sources & population decisions

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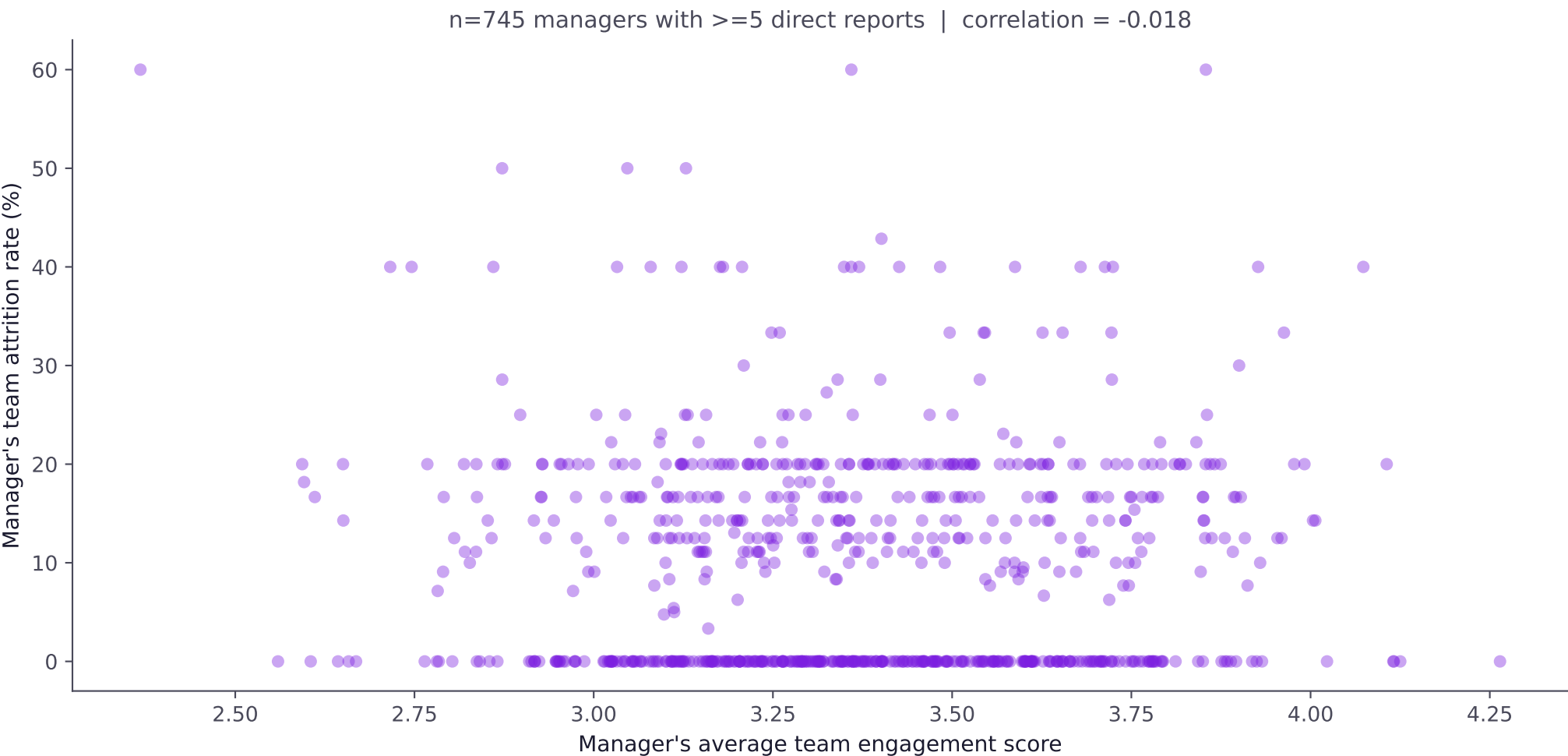
- employees.csv (13,403 rows, active+departed), attrition\_log.csv (1,400), engagement.csv (55,971 rows, 5 waves), performance.csv (34,979 rows). Joined on employee\_id. Observation window: 1 Jan 2024 - 31 Dec 2025.
- Org snapshot analysis -> active-only population (n=12,003).
- Attrition-rate analysis -> full roster, active+departed (n=13,403), since departed staff were part of the workforce-at-risk before leaving.
- Hiring-channel analysis -> hires within the observation window only, excluding 'acquisition' hire\_source (M&A transfers, not discretionary recruiting decisions).
- Engagement-trend analysis -> employees with  $\geq 2$  completed survey waves.
- response\_flag=False rows retained, not dropped — treated as a signal (see Finding 3).



# Equity & ethics checks performed — no red flags found

| By gender         |           |           |           |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-------------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gender            | Headcount | Avg compa | Attrition |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Female            | 6,385     | 0.95      | 10.6%     | • No material gender pay gap: compa-ratio flat across gender within the same role level (e.g. L3: F 0.947 vs M 0.946).                                                                 |
| Male              | 6,172     | 0.95      | 10.2%     |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Non-binary        | 489       | 0.94      | 11.0%     | • No material gender attrition gap.                                                                                                                                                    |
| Prefer not to say | 357       | 0.95      | 10.4%     |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|                   |           |           |           | • Female representation at L5+ in this dataset (59.2%) differs from the Annual Report figure (34.1%) — a documented data/report discrepancy, not evidence of bias in either direction. |

# We tested a 'bad manager' narrative — the data does not support it



45.1% of managers with 5+ reports had zero attrition in the window; their average team engagement (3.37) is statistically indistinguishable from the highest-attrition decile (3.36)

# Attrition rate by department and acquisition cohort

| Department           | Entity_A | Entity_B | Entity_C | NovaCorp-Origin |
|----------------------|----------|----------|----------|-----------------|
| Corporate Operations | 8.2%     | 16.6%    | 12.6%    | 11.2%           |
| Executive Leadership | 0.0%     | 2.8%     | 13.0%    | 10.3%           |
| Insurance            | 8.4%     | 16.0%    | 8.5%     | 9.7%            |
| Retail Banking       | 7.2%     | 13.6%    | 6.4%     | 9.3%            |
| Risk & Compliance    | 8.5%     | 16.6%    | 11.0%    | 11.6%           |
| Technology           | 7.2%     | 15.6%    | 10.1%    | 9.9%            |
| Wealth Management    | 6.3%     | 14.1%    | 8.4%     | 10.9%           |

Entity\_B x Risk & Compliance and Entity\_B x Corporate Operations are the two highest cells in the matrix, both above 16%.